Ben Morrell

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Hi Darpan,

Thanks for writing the brief the way you have. “Comfort being the founding member of a function, combining strategy with hands-on work” is the part of this job I actually want, and it is the part I have done three times.

At Watching That I was Head of Partnerships and I was the function. There was nothing there when I started. I built it, ran outbound BD to net-new targets, and signed Brightcove, a partner the company had chased for 3-4 years, plus three more across Europe/US/APAC.

Before that I spent five years at Brightcove in Asia. I recruited 15+ ISV and agency partners and the channel went on to produce 35% of regional pipeline. That was the number the function was run and reviewed on, which I think is the only sensible way to measure a partner program.

In terms of making it repeatable, Livepeer is the better example. There was no commercial process at all, so I put one in: forecasting, contracting cadence, deal documentation, and the CRM as the single source of truth.

On your partner universe of AI startups, developer tools, accelerators and venture funds - I build in that world rather than only sell into it. I ship LLM applications on the Claude API, a production remote MCP server, and my own go-to-market automation.

Alongside that I have advised 20+ SaaS/AI founders, and I host a GTM podcast, 26+ episodes with sales and partnerships leaders. That is where a lot of my warm conversations start.

To be clear - my relationships are strongest in video/SaaS and across APAC/EMEA, not a US AI-VC book. Some of those relationships I would be building from a standing start, and the podcast and the founder advisory work are the warm route in.

One practical note, as a qualifier rather than an apology: I am in Valencia, fully remote, engaged through a non-Spanish entity, and US-afternoon overlap is no problem. I have run a business across borders and time zones, literally from a 40-foot boat. Remote and self-directed is simply how I work.

Happy to hop on a call to talk through any of the above.

Thanks Darpan,
Ben Morrell